

Board: 2

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4♥

Declarer: North

Board: 4

Dealer: **West**

Contract: 4♠

Declarer: East

Board 2

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A 7 4
♥ J 8 6 3
♦ 10 5
♣ 9 8 4 3

♠ 10 6 3

♥ A 10 7 5 4

♦ A J 2

♣ A K



♠ K Q J 8

♥ -

♦ 9 7 6 4

♣ Q 10 6 5 2

♠ 9 5 2

♥ K Q 9 2

♦ K Q 8 3

♣ J 7

West

North

East

South

1♥

Pass

3♥

Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by North

You have 12 points which isn't quite enough to force to game.

It is just right for a limit raise though, so you bid 3♥.

Partner does bid the game.

South would play 4♥.

Click

North plays 4♥. The defense takes the first three ♠ tricks, then switches to a ♣.

North plays 4♥. The defense takes the first three ♠ tricks, then switches to a ♣.

Losers: ♠ 3 : ♥ ?? : ♦ 0 : ♣ 0 : Total = 3+??

With no more outside losers your task is very very simple:**DO NOT LOSE A TRUMP TRICK.**

There is no problem if trumps split 2-2 or 3-1, so you can put your mind to 4-0 splits only. If East holds ♥ J 8 6 3 then it won't matter whether your first trump play is ♥ A or ♥ K, you will still be able to finesse the ♥ J. But if West holds ♥ J 8 6 3 it is vital that you first play either the ♥ K or ♥ Q. If you start with the ♥ A you will have lost your finesse position. The general rule is to first play a high trump from the hand that has two. That preserves a finesse through either defender's ♥ J x x x.

Visualize the situation if your first play was the ♥ A. East would show out and you would learn that West held ♥ J 8 6 3 but you couldn't do anything about it.

Next visualize the situation if your first play was the ♥ K. East would show out and you would play the ♥ Q, then a small ♥ finessing your ♥ 10.

Finally visualize the situation if your first play was the ♥ K and it was West who showed out. You would play a small ♥ to your ♥ A, then lead a ♥ toward dummy finessing with the ♥ 9.

Using the correct Plan guarantees the contract however ♥s split.

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ K Q 9 2

♥ 9 5 2

♦ K 7

♣ K Q 8 3

♠ -

♥ A 8 7 4

♦ Q J 6 3 2

♣ 10 7 6 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A 8 7 5 4

♥ 10 6 3

♦ A 8

♣ A J 2

♠ J 10 6 3

♥ K Q J

♦ 10 9 5 4

♣ 9 5

West

1 ♣

2 ♠

All Pass

4 ♠ by East

only worried about a 4-0 trump split. The reason that it shows up right here is to point out the difference between J 8 6 3 and J 10 6 3.

North

Pass

Pass

East

1 ♠

4 ♠

South

Pass

Partner has opened and you have 14 points. You know you belong in game but there is no need to jump and use up bidding space. You respond 1 ♠.

Partner now bids 2 ♠.

You know you should be in game and now you know the suit. You bid 4 ♠.

East plays 4 ♠. The defense quickly takes three ♥ tricks, then switches to a ♦.

East plays 4 ♠. The defense quickly takes three ♥ tricks, then switches to a ♦.

Losers: ♠ 0? : ♥ 3 : ♦ 0 : ♣ 0 : Total = 3?

This Deal is **VERY** similar to Deal 9 in that you are

If North holds ♠ J 10 6 3 then there is nothing you can do about it - you will go down. If you lead a ♠ from dummy he will "split his honors" by playing the ♠ 10. This will force your ♠ A and he can just sit back and wait for his ♠ J to make a trick.

But if it is South with ♠ J 10 6 3 you can keep him from winning a ♠ trick, **IF YOUR FIRST ♠ PLAY IS THE ♠ A**. North shows out and you play a small ♠ toward dummy's ♠ K Q 9. If South plays low you insert the ♠ 9, if he plays one of his honors you win it, then return to your hand and finesse him out of the other honor.

When South holds four trumps you can pick them up if your first ♠ play is the ♠ A.

If your first ♠ was ♠ K or ♠ Q then it would be too late.

When North holds four trumps there is no way to avoid a loser. As soon as you lead the first small ♠ from dummy North will play the ♠ 10. That will force your ♠ A and leave him with ♠ J 6 3 behind dummy's ♠ K Q 9.

To summarize: If you are missing J x x x your first play should be from the hand with two honors. Then you will be able to finesse in either direction. If you are missing J 10 x x your first play should be honor from the hand with only one. This will leave you with a double-finesse position in one direction. If the other defender has the trumps there is nothing you can do.